

The second row of layers can be accessed by using Alt-1 (accesses layer directly below 1 in the Layer Management UI) and so forth.

Tools like Alt-H and H work only on particular layers, so if an object isn't seen it might be that it is either invisible or just on another layer, so while hiding and layer management are very similar and achieve the same purpose, they are not the same thing.

## Object and edit mode

Object and Edit mode are very important tools for modelling in Blender, and the difference between them is important for using the interface effectively.

Object mode is the default mode for Blender, and one can cross check this by looking in the panel on the bottom where the mode is written in a dropdown. You can go there and change the mode to edit mode with your mouse, or you can simply press the tab hotkey to go into edit mode.

In edit mode, everything is highlighted, and the cursor turns into a crosshair, which means that you can now edit faces and vertices separately, which helps a lot in modelling. We can right-click and select several vertices and deform them using our standard transformation tools (like G, M and R).

To go back to object mode, we can simply press tab again or use the drop down. Edit mode and Object mode both have separate histories, so we can utilize them to our benefit. Undoing in edit mode (Ctrl-Z) takes you back one step in the transformation but undoing in object mode just after exiting edit mode reverses everything done in the edit mode previously, because to object mode, going into edit mode (and the transformations made there) is considered one step.

Undoing in Object mode deletes all history of the object transformation in Edit mode, so redoing it by going back into Edit mode to undo the reversal step by step is not an option. This is one of the fallacies of Blender, and something to be very careful of.

## Meshes

Meshes and objects are very similar, except meshes are slightly more specific, a mesh is an object made up of polygons. We can see this by going into edit mode and seeing that the object is made up of faces and edges.

When creating an object (Shift-A), we see in the menu that there are several different options, the mesh created has editable polygons which is very useful for modelling. Other types of objects do not allow for much editing, as they are often mathematical equations of the shape instead of being a group of polygons forming a shape.